

# Chapter 27 — Biconsonantal / Geminate Disambiguation Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) identify the weak class (Biconsonantal or Geminate); (4) give the root and translate. Biconsonantal and Geminate forms are vocally identical — root knowledge is required. Answer key is on the last page.

Biconsonantal (II-ו/י): medial vowel letter ו or י retained in stem (e.g. וּכְנַח, שָׁכַח, בָּרַח, יָחַד). Geminate (R2=R3): same consonant at R2 and R3; no medial vowel letter (e.g. מָחַח, בָּבַח, חָח). Both classes share: Niphal perfect חָ (qamets); Hiphil perfect חָ (tsere); Hiphil imperfect יָ (qamets); Hiphil imperative חָ (qamets); Hiphil participle מַחֵ (tsere).

## Part A — Niphal: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Niphal. Identify whether each is Biconsonantal (medial ו/י) or Geminate (R2=R3). The prefix vowel pattern (חָ in perfect; יָ in imperfect) is identical for both classes.

| # | Form    | Ref        | Context                         | Stem | Conjugation | PGN | Class | Root |
|---|---------|------------|---------------------------------|------|-------------|-----|-------|------|
| 1 | וּכְנַח | Gen 41:32  | "the thing is ____ by God"      |      |             |     |       |      |
| 2 | וּבַח   | 1 Kgs 7:24 | "the gourds ____ it, ten to a   |      |             |     |       |      |
| 3 | יָחַד   | Psa 93:2   | "your throne ____ from of old"  |      |             |     |       |      |
| 4 | יָחַח   | Num 21:4   | "they traveled ____ Mount Edom" |      |             |     |       |      |
| 5 | יָחַח   | Psa 57:8   | "my heart is ____, O God"       |      |             |     |       |      |
| 6 | יָחַח   | Num 34:4   | "your border ____ from the      |      |             |     |       |      |
| 7 | יָחַח   | Lam 3:40   | "let us examine and ____ to the |      |             |     |       |      |
| 8 | יָחַח   | 1 Sam 3:12 | "when I ____ what I have        |      |             |     |       |      |

## Part B — Hiphil: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Hiphil. Hiphil prefix patterns: חָ (perfect) · יָ (imperfect) · חָ (imperative) · מַחֵ (participle). These are identical for Biconsonantal and Geminate — root knowledge is the only distinguisher.

| #  | Form  | Ref        | Context                          | Stem | Conjugation | PGN | Class | Root |
|----|-------|------------|----------------------------------|------|-------------|-----|-------|------|
| 9  | יָחַח | Gen 6:18   | "I will ____ my covenant with    |      |             |     |       |      |
| 10 | יָחַח | 2 Sam 2:22 | "____ from following me"         |      |             |     |       |      |
| 11 | יָחַח | Deut 18:15 | "the LORD will ____ a prophet"   |      |             |     |       |      |
| 12 | יָחַח | Eccl 1:6   | "the wind ____ to the south"     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 13 | יָחַח | Deut 27:26 | "____ the words of this law"     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 14 | יָחַח | 2 Sam 2:22 | "____ from following me"         |      |             |     |       |      |
| 15 | יָחַח | 1 Sam 2:8  | "He ____ the poor from the dust" |      |             |     |       |      |
| 16 | יָחַח | Jer 21:4   | "I am turning around the         |      |             |     |       |      |

## Part C — Mixed: Stem and Class Both Unknown

Identify both the stem (Niphal/Hiphal/Qal/Hophal) and the class. Part C includes Qal and Hophal forms as distractors — not every Biconsonantal form is Niphal or Hiphil.

| #  | Form     | Ref       | Context                            | Stem | Conjugation | PGN | Class | Root |
|----|----------|-----------|------------------------------------|------|-------------|-----|-------|------|
| 17 | נָמוּג   | Isa 14:31 | "all Philistia ____"               |      |             |     |       |      |
| 18 | הִמָּטוּ | Deu 1:28  | "our brothers ____ our hearts"     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 19 | יָרָם    | Isa 52:13 | "my servant shall be high and      |      |             |     |       |      |
| 20 | יָרָם    | Psa 99:2  | "great is the LORD, ____ above     |      |             |     |       |      |
| 21 | הִרָּיִם | Gen 14:22 | "I have ____ my hand to the        |      |             |     |       |      |
| 22 | הוֹרָם   | Lev 4:10  | "just as it is ____ from the peace |      |             |     |       |      |
| 23 | יָשׁוּב  | Hos 14:8  | "they ____ in the shade"           |      |             |     |       |      |
| 24 | יִשָּׁב  | Lam 1:11  | "all her people ____ to find       |      |             |     |       |      |

### Reflection Questions

- Items 1 (נָמוּג) and 2 (הִמָּטוּ) have the same נ. prefix. What is the only reliable way to identify נָמוּג as Biconsonantal (root נ.מ.ג) and הִמָּטוּ as Geminate (root ט.מ.ט)?
- Items 9 (מִיָּקָה) and 10 (מִיָּסָה) both have ה. prefix (tsere). One retains a medial vowel letter; the other shows a contracted stem. Describe precisely what the medial position of each form looks like and how that reflects the root structure.
- Items 11 (מִיָּקָה) and 12 (מִיָּסָה) are both Hiphal imperfect 3ms. You encounter an unknown form יָדָל. What question must you ask to determine if it is Biconsonantal or Geminate?
- Items 19 (יָרָם) and 21 (הִרָּיִם) come from the same root (מ.ר.) but differ in stem. What vowel under R2 distinguishes the Niphal imperfect from the Hiphal perfect?
- Item 22 (הוֹרָם) was classified as Hophal. How does the Hophal Biconsonantal prefix (וה.) differ from Niphal (נ.) and Hiphal (ה.), and what does it tell you about the semantics?

### Answer Key

| #  | Form    | Stem          | Answer                                                                                                            |
|----|---------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | נָכֹן   | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect/Ptc · 3ms/ms · Biconsonantal · נִּכּוּן — "is established / firm" — נִּ prefix (qamets); medial ו vowel   |
| 2  | נָסַב   | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · נִּבְּסָ — "encircled / went around" — נִּ prefix (qamets); R2=R3=ב = Geminate;        |
| 3  | יִכּוֹן | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִכּוּן — "is established" — יִּ + dagesh in כּ + holem-vav = Niphal            |
| 4  | יִסַּב  | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִּבְּסָ — "went around" — יִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3 doubled) + holem =               |
| 5  | הִכּוֹן | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִכּוּן — "is ready / prepared" — הִּ + dagesh + holem-vav = Niphal               |
| 6  | הִסַּב  | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִּבְּסָ — "turned / went around" — הִּ + dagesh in ס (R2=R3) + holem = Niphal         |
| 7  | נָשׁוּב | <b>Niphal</b> | Cohortative · 1cp · Biconsonantal · נִּבּוּשׁ — "let us return" — נִּ prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;   |
| 8  | נִתֵּם  | <b>Niphal</b> | Inf. Const. · — · Geminate · נִתְּמָ — "to be completed / finished" — נִּ prefix + holem = Niphal Geminate        |
| 9  | הִקִּים | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "established / raised up" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; medial ו vowel  |
| 10 | הִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · הִּבְּסָ — "turned aside" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; no medial vowel letter,       |
| 11 | יִקִּים | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִקֵּם — "will raise up" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal           |
| 12 | יִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · יִּבְּסָ — "causes to go around / turns" — יִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil; no          |
| 13 | הִקֵּם  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperative · 2ms · Biconsonantal · הִקֵּם — "raise up! / confirm!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative;     |
| 14 | הִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Imperative · 2ms · Geminate · הִּבְּסָ — "turn aside!" — הִּ prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative; same vowels     |
| 15 | מִקִּים | <b>Hiphil</b> | Participle · ms · Biconsonantal · מִקֵּם — "one who raises up" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; medial ו |
| 16 | מִסִּב  | <b>Hiphil</b> | Participle · ms · Geminate · מִּבְּסָ — "turning / surrounding" — מִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; no      |
| 17 | נִמּוּג | <b>Niphal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · נִמּוּג — "melted / dissolved" — נִּ prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;    |
| 18 | הִמָּסָ | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3cp · Geminate · הִמָּסָ — "caused to melt" — הִּ prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; R2=R3=ס = Geminate;          |
| 19 | יִרָם   | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "will be exalted / lifted up" — יִּ prefix + qibbutz under R2           |
| 20 | יִרָם   | <b>Niphal</b> | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יִרָם — "is exalted / high" — יִּ prefix + holem under R2 = Niphal              |
| 21 | הִרָם   | <b>Hiphil</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הִרָם — "lifted up / swore an oath" — הִּ prefix (tsere) + chiriq-yod = Hiphil    |
| 22 | הוּרָם  | <b>Hophal</b> | Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · הוּרָם — "was lifted off / removed" — הוּ prefix (holem-vav) = Hophal             |
| 23 | יָשׁוּב | <b>Qal</b>    | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָשׁוּב — "will dwell / return" — Qal Biconsonantal — no Niphal נ or Hiphil     |
| 24 | יָשַׁב  | <b>Qal</b>    | Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · יָשַׁב — "returned / went around" — Qal Biconsonantal; holem vowel              |